System Verification and Validation Plan for Software Engineering

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1 Symbols, Abbreviations, and Acronyms

symbol	description
ASSURE	Accreditation and Scheduling Support for Undergraduate Review and Evaluation
CAS	Department of Computing and Software
CEAB	Canadian Engineering Accreditation Board, the organization responsible for accrediting undergraduate engineering programs in Canada.
FMEA	Failure Mode and Effect Analysis
LLM	Large Language Model
PDF	Portable Document Format
PoC	Proof of Concept
SRS	Software Requirements Specification [1]
T	Test
V&V	Verification and Validation

This document outlines the Verification and Validation (V&V) Plan for ASSURE, the Accreditation and Scheduling Support for Undergraduate Review and Evaluation system. It describes the V&V objectives, scope, testing strategies, tools, and team responsibilities, as well as the planned activities and criteria used to evaluate whether the system meets its requirements and is ready for deployment.

2 General Information

2.1 Summary

The software under test is ASSURE (Accreditation and Scheduling Support for Undergraduate Review and Evaluation), which is a course-outline review system for the Department of Computing and Software (CAS) at McMaster University.

ASSURE accepts a batch of course outlines in PDF (Word and LaTeX document support will be a future feature). A replaceable (black box) locally hosted open-weight large language model (LLM) extracts each assessment's name, date, weight, and learning outcomes, and it either cites the passage each value came from or reports that it cannot find the value. The system checks the extracted information against McMaster University's Undergraduate Course Management Policy [2], academic-calendar restrictions, and the Canadian Engineering Accreditation Board's (CEAB) Accreditation Criteria and Procedures [3], and flags missing, incomplete, or non-compliant information for review. Its dashboard supports filtering by course, year, and program. It also displays term completeness, workload or scheduling conflicts, and allows users to override or correct extracted values. The system also stores the reviewed data for export, while its shared calendar presents assessment deadlines across CAS courses and highlights items that need attention.

2.2 Objectives

The primary objective of the Verification and Validation (V&V) process is to build confidence that the CAS system functions correctly and reliably, as well as ensuring that the information it produces is accurate and traceable to the original course outlines. Emphasis will be placed on verifying the accuracy

of document processing and information extraction, including outputs generated through the external LLM. The system must also reliably support its core functionality, including the management and presentation of extracted information, to ensure that CAS administrators and the associate chairs can use the results to review course outlines against CEAB requirements and McMaster policies.

Given resource and time constraints, certain attributes will receive less attention during the V&V process. For example, usability studies involving a large group of users and performance testing under high workloads will be outside the scope of this project. Basic usability and performance checks will still be conducted, but testing efforts will prioritize correctness, reliability, and traceability due to their greater impact and importance on the system's core purpose. Additionally, the internal implementation of external dependencies, such as third-party document processing libraries and the LLM, will not be independently verified by the team. Instead, these will be treated as externally maintained components, with a focus on integration testing and evaluating the accuracy of their outputs.

2.3 Custom Documents

The project includes two approved Custom Documents that support the design process and end-user adoption:

1. **Fall Term CD: Wireframe Report.** The wireframe report will document the proposed administrative dashboard, including the shared assessment calendar, course filtering tools, and scheduling recommendation displays. The wireframes will be reviewed with the project clients and stakeholders to confirm that the navigation, component interactions, and workflows reflect their needs before front-end implementation begins. Feedback from this review will be used to revise the interface design.

2. **Winter Term CD: User Manual.** The user manual will provide instructors and CAS administrative staff with step-by-step instructions for uploading course outlines, filtering the centralized assessment calendar, exporting database records, and reviewing policy compliance flags and scheduling recommendations. The manual will be checked against

the implemented system and reviewed for completeness, clarity, and whether users can follow its procedures to complete the documented tasks.

2.4 Relevant Documentation

This plan verifies the requirements and design recorded in the team's other project documents, and it checks the system against external policies and standards. Each document below is listed with the part of this plan that depends on it.

Project documents

Software Requirements Specification (SRS) [1]:
defines the functional (FR), nonfunctional (NFR), data (DR), and AI and machine learning (AIR) requirements that the system tests in Section 4 verify. Its Appendix C gives the values of the symbolic constants used in the tests, and its evaluation metrics set the accuracy targets that the nonfunctional tests measure.

Hazard Analysis [4]:
defines the safety and security requirements (SSR) that are tested alongside the SRS requirements. Its Failure Mode and Effect Analysis identifies the failures, such as unreadable outlines and restricted dates, that the tests are designed to expose.

Problem Statement and Goals [5]:
states the project goals and their success measures. Software validation checks the system against these goals with the supervisors.

Development Plan [6]:
specifies the team's workflow, coding standards, and tools, including Pytest, Vitest, Ruff, ESLint, and GitHub Actions. The automated testing, implementation verification, and plan verification activities in this document use that workflow and those tools.

Module Guide [7] and Module Interface Specification [8]:
define the modules and their interfaces. Design verification reviews these documents, and the unit tests in Section 5 are organized by their modules.

Verification and Validation Report [9]:
records the results of carrying out this plan, including test results, review findings, and any changes made because of them.

External policies and standards.

Undergraduate Course Management Policy [2]:
defines the course outline rules and restricted periods that the compliance and restricted-period tests check against.

CEAB Accreditation Criteria and Procedures [3]:
defines the graduate attributes used in the learning outcome and graduate attribute tests.

WCAG 2.0 [10] and the AODA [11, 12]:
define the accessibility criteria that the accessibility checks in the nonfunctional tests apply.

3 Plan

This section describes the activities and responsibilities involved in verifying and validating ASSURE throughout development. It outlines the team's roles, the approaches used to verify the SRS and design, the process for reviewing the V&V Plan and implementation, the automated testing tools, and the methods used to validate the completed system. The individual tests are given in Sections 4 and 5.

3.1 Verification and Validation Team

The members will verify the requirements from the SRS [1] including but not limited to functional requirements, nonfunctional requirements, data requirements and AI requirements. Matt Vonk and Connie Carrabs share the supervisor role.

Table 1: Verification and Validation Team

Name	Role	Responsibilities
Vanessa Lai	Team member	Verifies the functional requirements. Writes the functional system tests in this document.
Harmanpreet Singh Sagar	Team member	Verifies the data and privacy requirements.
Shivya Mehta	Team member	Verifies the non functional requirements. Writes the non functional system tests in this document.
Anindita Bornomala	Team member	Verifies the AI and machine learning requirements.
Matt Vonk and Connie Carrabs	Supervisors	Do not author tests or VnV artifacts. Review verification results presented by the team in regular meetings (pass/fail summaries, open issues, and planned fixes). Provides feedback and confirms that stakeholder needs are verified.

3.2 SRS Verification

The SRS will be verified through a combination of structured internal reviews, as well as receiving feedback from primary stakeholders (CAS administrators, associate chairs). Team members will review the SRS to assess the completeness, clarity, consistency, feasibility, and verifiability of the requirements. To ensure a systematic review, the team will use the following checklist for verification:

- Completeness: Verify that all required system functions and relevant constraints are documented.
- Clarity: Ensure that each requirement is clearly stated and free of ambiguity.
- Consistency: Verify that the requirements do not conflict with one another and use consistent terminology.

- Feasibility: Ensure that each requirement can realistically be implemented within the project's technical constraints.
- Verifiability: Ensure that each requirement can be tested or verified using defined criteria.
- Traceability: Verify that each requirement can be linked to its relevant stakeholder needs, as well as identified risks in the Hazard Analysis.

The SRS will be reviewed with the project's TA (Lucas Dutton) and primary stakeholders (Matt Vonk, Connie Carrabs, Spencer Smith, Sebastien Mosser) during the scheduled biweekly meetings. Feedback on the requirements will be to determine whether the functionality accurately reflects stakeholder needs and project expectations. The team will encourage reviewers to identify any missing requirements or unclear descriptions, and any issues identified during reviews will be documented and tracked using GitHub Issues. The team will then address the feedback, update the SRS as needed, and review the changes to ensure that identified issues have been resolved.

3.3 Design Verification

Methods we will use for design verification.

- **Testing.** We will run design checks against the planned behaviour. Examples include outline intake, extraction with a source citation, confirmation before use, restricted-period and weight flags without the large language model (LLM), and rejecting a bad file. Each check will name SRS [1] or Hazard Analysis [4] requirement it covers, and will state a concrete expected result.
- **Analysis.** We will review the design on paper. We will revisit the Failure Mode and Effect Analysis (FMEA) in the Hazard Analysis and ask whether each mitigation still has a place in the design. If something is deferred, we will point to the Hazard Analysis roadmap.
- **Inspection.** A teammate who did not write the design will use a checklist covering the system components C1 to C11 from the Hazard Analysis. Our supervisors will inspect the design in a meeting when needed. Classmate peer reviewers will use the same checklist and leave comments as GitHub issues.

- **Similarity.** We will compare a new design to an earlier accepted design choice from the Development Plan [6], such as a replaceable LLM interface. For example, switching the LLM from Copilot to Gemma. If we change that choice, we will explain why the change still fits the SRS and Hazard Analysis.

Results and pass/fail data. For each design check, we will record which design part we looked at, which SRS or Hazard Analysis requirement we used as the expected result, what we observed, and whether it passed or failed.

Non-conformances and deviations. If a design check fails, we will open a GitHub issue that names the design part and what it failed against. The issue will also say how we fixed it, or why we are allowing a deviation for now, before we treat the design as ready to implement.

3.4 Verification and Validation Plan Verification

The VnV plan is itself verified before it is submitted, and again before the final version, once the unit test sections are complete. Five activities are used, summarized in Table 2. Each one produces a record, so the team can show what was checked and what was changed as a result.

Table 2: VnV Plan Verification Activities

Activity	**Done by**	**Evidence recorded**
Checklist review	A member who did not write the section	Pull request review comments and approval
Traceability and coverage check	Traceability table owner	Gaps found, opened as GitHub issues
Test dry run	A member who did not write the tests	Tests checked and tests rewritten
Seeded fault review	Whole team	Table 3, with any test added
External review	Team 22, the TA, and the supervisors	Peer review issues, TA feedback issues, and supervisor meeting notes

Checklist review of each section. Every section is added through a pull request, and a team member who did not write it reviews it against the course VnV checklist. The reviewer checks, in particular, that each test has specific input, an explicit expected output, and a derivation for that output, and that symbolic constants are used instead of literal values. Each checklist item that is not met becomes a review comment, and the pull request is merged only after every comment is resolved or answered with a reason.

Traceability and coverage check. The team member responsible for the traceability tables checks the whole plan before it is submitted:

- every requirement in the SRS [1] and every safety and security requirement in the Hazard Analysis [4] appears in Table 4;
- every requirement is verified by at least one system test;
- every test identifier in the traceability tables is defined in the system or unit test sections, and every defined test is traced; and
- every module is traced to at least one unit test and one system test.

Each gap found is opened as a GitHub issue and assigned to the author of the affected section.

Test dry run. For each area of system tests, a team member who did not write the tests selects three of them and walks through each one using only the information in this document. The test passes the dry run if the member can name the input files, carry out the steps, and state the expected output without asking the author. A test that fails the dry run is rewritten before submission. This checks that someone outside the team could run the tests once the product is built.

Seeded fault review. This is a form of mutation testing applied to the plan. The team lists faults that a plausible implementation could contain, and for each fault identifies the planned test that would fail because of it. Table 3 gives the initial list. A fault that no planned test would detect shows a missing test, and a test is added for it. The review is held in a team meeting, and the target is that every seeded fault is detected by at least one planned test.

Table 3: Seeded Faults and the Tests That Detect Them

Seeded fault	**Detected by**
Weights that total 90% pass the weight check.	ST-FR13
A missing required outline section is not reported.	ST-FR13
A date marked TBD is stored as a date instead of being flagged as missing.	ST-FR4
A blank weight is filled with a guessed value.	ST-FR4
An extracted value is stored without a citation to its source passage.	ST-FR2
An unconfirmed assessment appears in the calendar.	ST-FR5
An assessment dated in reading week is not reported.	ST-FR9
A suggested date falls in a restricted period.	ST-FR11
An assessment date changes without the instructor's approval.	ST-FR12
A course missing from the master course sheet is shown with no findings.	ST-FR14
An instructor can change another instructor's course.	ST-FR16
A file of 5 MB or larger is accepted for processing.	ST-FR1
A protected page opens without logging in.	ST-FR15
An instructor can export the CSV file.	ST-FR17
A failed upload deletes or changes stored records.	NFR-REL-01
A credential appears in the deployment configuration or logs.	NFR-SEC-01

External review. Three groups outside the team review the plan:

- **Peer review team:** Team 22, the primary reviewer, reviews the plan and opens GitHub issues using the repository's peer review template.

The team answers each issue by fixing it in a linked pull request, or by closing it with a stated reason.

- **Teaching assistant:** The team asks the TA the following three questions during during the informal presentation, the team asks the TA three questions. Is the set of sample outlines large enough to show that the accuracy targets in NFR1 are met? Are the planned reviews, inspections, and walkthroughs enough to support the dynamic tests? Can the plan be completed in the time available? The TA's answers are recorded as GitHub issues.

- **Supervisors:** At a supervisor meeting, the team presents the system test areas and the sample outlines used as test input, and asks Matt Vonk and Connie Carrabs whether the outlines represent CAS courses and whether the policy rules being tested are the ones the department applies. Their answers are recorded in the meeting notes, and any change becomes an issue.

3.5 Implementation Verification

Implementation verification asks whether ASSURE was built to match its requirements and design. The plan combines dynamic tests with a small set of static techniques aimed at those risks.

- **System testing (dynamic).** Black-box, end-to-end checks of FR behaviour on the running system, using the inputs and expected results in Section 4. These tests catch integration failures that unit tests miss (upload through export, role boundaries, conflict results after a date change).

- **Unit testing (dynamic).** Module-level tests against the MIS. Most will be automatic. Priority modules are extraction parsing, conflict and cluster detection, compliance rules, and access control.

- **Pull-request code review (static).** Every change merged to `main` needs at least one teammate who did not author it. The reviewer checks it with the related requirement or issue, that tests cover the change, and for good code quality.

- **Code walkthroughs (static).** For large features (extraction, conflict detection, compliance, and access control), the team will hold a bug-checking meeting to walk through the code together and note issues. Checklist:
  - Does the code match the MIS?
  - Are missing or TBD fields flagged, not invented?
  - Are restricted periods, cluster rules, and role checks enforced?
  - Are failure paths explicit (reject, deny, not-checked)?
  - Is the code clean and readable?

  Findings are logged as GitHub issues.

3.6 Automated Testing and Verification Tools

The primary coding language for the system will be Python, so the team will use the following automated testing and verification tools to support code quality, identify potential defects, and evaluate test coverage throughout development:

- Pytest: A Python testing framework that will be used to develop and execute automated unit tests for individual functions and modules.
- Pytest-cov: A code coverage tool that will be used alongside Pytest to measure the proportion of source code executed during testing. Coverage reports will be reviewed to identify parts of code that may require additional testing.
- Ruff: A Python linter and static analysis tool that will be used to identify potential errors, enforce consistent coding standards, and improve code quality.
- GitHub Actions: A continuous integration tool that will automatically run the project's test suite and code quality checks when changes are pushed to the repository.

Special attention will be paid to the components responsible for the fundamental functions of the system, such as document processing, information

extraction, and data validation. The team will review automated test results to identify and resolve issues before integrating changes into the main codebase. The specific configuration and use of these tools may be adjusted as development and implementation progresses.

3.7 Software Validation

Software validation will assess whether the implemented system solves the problem identified by CAS administrators and course instructors, rather than only checking whether individual requirements pass their verification tests. Validation will use representative course outlines from the 2025–2026 academic year. The team will prepare an answer key for the assessment dates, assessment weights, learning outcomes, missing or incomplete fields, and policy or CEAB issues in these outlines. The extracted results and compliance flags will be reviewed against this answer key and discussed with the project stakeholders.

Stakeholder Review and Demonstration The team will demonstrate the MVP to the CAS supervisors and other project stakeholders after the core workflows are implemented. The demonstration will include uploading a course outline, reviewing extracted information, correcting or confirming flagged values, viewing and filtering the assessment calendar, reviewing compliance notifications, viewing scheduling recommendations, and exporting available records. Stakeholders will assess whether the workflows, terminology, displayed information, and generated recommendations support their administrative and instructional tasks. Their feedback will be recorded as accepted changes, clarification requests, or out-of-scope requests and used to update the requirements, interface, or documentation where appropriate.

User Task Validation Representative CAS administrators and primary stakeholders will be invited to complete the core workflows without implementation team assistance. The team will record whether each participant can upload an outline, review extracted information, interpret a flagged issue, filter the calendar, and export records. Participants will also be asked whether the system's results are understandable and whether the system supports their expected workflow. Task completion results will be evaluated against the 80% usability target, while qualitative feedback will be used to

identify usability issues not captured by the functional tests.

Validation Evidence The validation record will include the test outlines and answer key version, stakeholder demonstration notes, participant task results, survey or interview feedback, and the disposition of requested changes. Validation results will be reported with the corresponding system-test results in this document and reviewed against the goals and user-related requirements in the SRS. Validation will not treat agreement with the answer key alone as evidence of usefulness: stakeholder feedback and user task performance must also show that the calendar, review workflow, compliance flags, recommendations, and exports are understandable and useful to their intended users.

4 System Tests

This section describes the system-level tests for ASSURE. Section 4.1 covers the functional requirements in the SRS [1]. There is one system test for each functional requirement, labeled ST-FR1 through ST-FR17, followed by ST-FR18 through ST-FR23 for the new requirements and the safety and security requirements. The tests are grouped the same way as the SRS: outline intake and extraction, calendar and conflict detection, scheduling suggestions, compliance checking, and access and export.

4.1 Tests for Functional Requirements

Each test below checks one functional requirement end to end through the running system. The inputs (files, dates, accounts, and expected values) are stated in each test.

There is one system test for each functional requirement (FR1–FR17). Some tests check more than one input case (for example, valid and invalid uploads in ST-FR1).

For this document version, outline intake is **PDF only**, and other formats will be supported later. For additional formats, new intake tests will be added. The max outline size is 5 MB, as defined in `SSR_AcceptedFiles`. Symbolic constants used in the tests below (cluster window, cluster threshold, min alternatives, weight total) are from Appendix C of the SRS [1].

4.1.1 Outline Intake and Extraction

These tests cover SRS requirements FR1 to FR6.

1. ST-FR1: Outline intake (FR1)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: A CAS administrator is logged in. No outline is stored for the selected course in the current term.

   Input/Condition: (a) A valid PDF course outline for that course, smaller than the max outline size (5 MB); (b) the same outline content saved in a non-PDF file format; (c) a PDF of the same outline larger than 5 MB.

   Output/Result: (a) The system accepts the upload, stores the outline for that course, and shows a success message. (b) and (c) The system rejects the file before processing and does not store an outline.

   Test Case Derivation: FR1 requires PDF outline intake from a CAS administrator or instructor. `SSR_AcceptedFiles` requires rejecting non-PDF and oversized files before processing.

   How test will be performed: The tester uploads (a)–(c) through the web interface and records whether each file is accepted or rejected. A second pass with an instructor account confirms that the same valid PDF upload path is available to instructors.

2. ST-FR2: Extract assessments (FR2)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: A valid PDF course outline for the selected course is stored. Extraction has not been confirmed.

   Input/Condition: The stored PDF, which contains Midterm 1 (weight 30%, dated 2026-02-10), Assignment 1 (blank weight, dated 2026-01-20), and Final Exam (weight 50%, date TBD).

   Output/Result: The system shows three assessments with those names, types, dates, and weights. Each extracted value includes a citation to

its source passage in the outline. The Final Exam date and Assignment 1 weight remain empty or marked missing; the system does not invent values for them.

Test Case Derivation: FR2 requires extraction of each assessment's name, type, date, and weight. The blank weight and TBD date also set up FR4.

How test will be performed: The tester runs extraction and compares the structured result to a handwritten answer key for that PDF.

3. ST-FR3: Extract learning outcomes (FR3)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: A valid PDF course outline for the selected course is stored. The outline includes at least three learning outcomes that identify graduate attributes by number, by name, and by description only.

   Input/Condition: The stored outline, which contains those three learning outcomes: one with GA numbers beside it, one that names the attribute in words, and one that only describes the attribute.

   Output/Result: All three outcomes appear with their text. The system records the graduate attributes addressed in each of the number, name, and description cases. Each extracted value cites its source passage.

   Test Case Derivation: FR3 requires extraction of learning outcomes and the graduate attributes each addresses, whether listed by number, name, or description.

   How test will be performed: The tester runs extraction and compares the outcomes and GA mappings to the handwritten answer key.

4. ST-FR4: Flag missing fields (FR4)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: A valid PDF course outline has been extracted into structured assessments, including Final Exam with date TBD and Assignment 1 with a blank weight.

   Input/Condition: The extracted assessment list that includes Final Exam (date TBD) and Assignment 1 (blank weight).

Output/Result: The system flags the TBD date and the blank weight as missing fields. It does not fill either field with a guessed value.

Test Case Derivation: FR4 requires flagging of any extracted field that is missing, including a date marked TBD.

How test will be performed: The tester inspects the extraction review screen and compares the missing-field flags to the handwritten answer key.

5. ST-FR5: Confirm extracted data (FR5)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: Extracted assessment data for the selected course is shown on the review screen and has not been confirmed.

   Input/Condition: The reviewer confirms all assessments except the Final Exam, which remains unconfirmed.

   Output/Result: Confirmed assessments appear in calendar, conflict, and compliance views. The unconfirmed Final Exam does not appear in those views until it is confirmed.

   Test Case Derivation: FR5 requires user review and confirmation before extracted data is used for calendar, conflict detection, or compliance checking.

   How test will be performed: The tester opens the calendar and compliance views before confirmation, after confirming all assessments except the Final Exam, and after confirming the Final Exam.

6. ST-FR6: Tentative dates (FR6)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: An instructor for a course is logged in. An assessment for that course has a missing date.

   Input/Condition: The instructor enters the tentative date 2026-02-17 for that assessment, then updates it to 2026-02-24.

   Output/Result: After each change, the stored date is shown as tentative. The final stored date is 2026-02-24. An instructor for a different course cannot change this date.

Test Case Derivation: FR6 allows an instructor to enter and update tentative assessment dates for their own courses.

How test will be performed: The course instructor sets and updates the date. A second instructor account for a different course is used to verify that the date cannot be edited.

4.1.2 Calendar and Conflict Detection

These tests cover SRS requirements FR7 to FR10.

1. ST-FR7: Shared calendar (FR7)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: Confirmed and tentative dates exist for at least two courses in the same program and year level.

   Input/Condition: (a) Filter the shared calendar by a selected program and year level; (b) then filter by one selected course alone.

   Output/Result: Under (a), confirmed and tentative dates for matching courses appear, tentative dates are visually marked, and courses from other programs do not appear. Under (b), only that course's events appear.

   Test Case Derivation: FR7 requires a shared calendar filtered by course, year, and program, with tentative dates marked.

   How test will be performed: The tester applies each filter and compares the visible events to the stored assessments.

2. ST-FR8: Workload cluster (FR8)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Automatic

   Initial State: Confirmed assessments for one cohort are loaded so that four assessments fall inside one 7-day cluster window. A second cohort has only two assessments in that same window. The cluster threshold is set to 3.

   Input/Condition: The loaded cohort assessments and the cluster threshold of 3.

Output/Result: The system flags the first cohort's window as a workload cluster. The second cohort is not flagged for that window.

Test Case Derivation: FR8 requires identifying cluster windows where a cohort has more assessments than the configurable threshold.

How test will be performed: A scripted system test loads the fixture data and asserts which windows are flagged.

3. ST-FR9: Restricted periods (FR9)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Automatic

   Initial State: The academic calendar for the term includes a reading week (recess) and a final examination or test-ban period (`SSR_RestrictedDates`).

   Input/Condition: One confirmed assessment dated inside reading week, one dated inside the exam or test-ban period, and one dated outside all restricted periods.

   Output/Result: The reading-week and exam or test-ban assessments are flagged as restricted. The unrestricted assessment is not flagged for this check.

   Test Case Derivation: FR9 requires identifying assessments scheduled in periods restricted by McMaster policy (for example, final exam periods). H6-4 calls for covering each restricted-period type used in the calendar.

   How test will be performed: A scripted system test runs conflict detection and checks the restricted-period findings against the loaded academic calendar.

4. ST-FR10: Re-analyze conflicts (FR10)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Automatic

   Initial State: Conflict results are stored that flag a workload cluster for one cohort (four assessments inside a 7-day window with a cluster threshold of 3).

   Input/Condition: An instructor changes one assessment date so that the cluster no longer exceeds the cluster threshold of 3.

Output/Result: Conflict detection runs again for the affected courses and cohorts. The previous cluster flag is cleared.

Test Case Derivation: FR10 requires re-running conflict detection when an assessment date is added or changed.

How test will be performed: A scripted system test updates the date and asserts the refreshed conflict results.

4.1.3 Scheduling Suggestions

These tests cover SRS requirements FR11 and FR12.

1. ST-FR11: Suggest alternative dates (FR11)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: One assessment is in a detected conflict, and another has a TBD date. The instructor for that course is logged in.

   Input/Condition: (a) The instructor explicitly requests suggestions for both assessments; (b) the instructor does not request suggestions.

   Output/Result: Under (a), the system offers at least two feasible dates for the conflicted assessment and suggestions for the TBD assessment, and no suggested date falls in a restricted period. Under (b), no suggestions are created.

   Test Case Derivation: FR11 requires alternative dates on explicit instructor request for conflicted or TBD assessments.

   How test will be performed: The tester requests suggestions and records the dates and explanations shown. A second run without a request confirms that no suggestions appear automatically.

2. ST-FR12: No automatic date change (FR12)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: Alternative date suggestions for a conflicted or TBD assessment are pending. The responsible instructor is logged in.

   Input/Condition: (a) The instructor rejects all suggestions; (b) in a second trial, the instructor accepts one suggestion.

Output/Result: After (a), the assessment date is unchanged. After (b), the stored date is the accepted suggestion and changes only because the instructor approved it.

Test Case Derivation: FR12 requires that an assessment date does not change without the responsible instructor's approval.

How test will be performed: The tester rejects all suggestions, then accepts one suggestion in a second trial, and checks the stored date after each action.

4.1.4 Compliance Checking

These tests cover SRS requirements FR13 and FR14.

1. ST-FR13: Policy compliance (FR13)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: A confirmed outline has assessment weights that sum to 90% and omits one required outline element named in the answer key (from the Undergraduate Course Management Policy rules encoded for FR13). A second confirmed outline that satisfies the same rules is available as a clean control.

   Input/Condition: (a) The defective confirmed outline and the encoded McMaster course-outline policy rules; (b) the clean control outline and the same rules.

   Output/Result: Under (a), the system reports a finding for the omitted required element and a finding that weights do not total 100%, and it lists which rules were checked (`SSR_CheckCoverage`). Under (b), the clean control produces no false weight-total failure.

   Test Case Derivation: FR13 requires checking outlines against McMaster policy rules, including required sections and weights totalling 100%. Related encoded rules include a maximum single weight of 75% and early-feedback minima.

   How test will be performed: The tester runs compliance on the defective outline and on the clean control outline and compares the findings to the answer key.

2. ST-FR14: Graduate attribute check (FR14)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: The master course sheet expects GAs 1, 2, and 5 for the selected course. The confirmed outline for that course lists GAs 1 and 2 only. A second course code has no master-sheet row.

   Input/Condition: (a) The confirmed learning-outcome GAs and the master course sheet row for the selected course; (b) the second course code with no master-sheet row.

   Output/Result: Under (a), the system flags GA 5 as missing or inconsistent. Under (b), the course absent from the master sheet is reported as not checked, not as having no findings.

   Test Case Derivation: FR14 requires comparing outline GA numbers with the master course sheet and flagging missing or inconsistent values. `SSR_CheckCoverage` / H5-5 require the not-checked wording.

   How test will be performed: The tester runs the GA check on both courses and records the findings text.

4.1.5 Access and Export

These tests cover SRS requirements FR15 to FR17.

1. ST-FR15: Login required (FR15)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: The tester is logged out.

   Input/Condition: A request to open the dashboard or a course page while logged out.

   Output/Result: The system denies access and prompts for login. After a valid login, the same page is reachable.

   Test Case Derivation: FR15 requires users to log in before they can view or change any data.

   How test will be performed: The tester opens protected URLs while logged out, then logs in and retries the same URLs.

2. ST-FR16: Role-based access (FR16)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: An administrator account and an instructor account exist. The instructor owns only one course.

   Input/Condition: (a) The instructor attempts to edit another instructor's course; (b) the administrator edits that same course.

   Output/Result: Under (a), the instructor's change is denied. Under (b), the administrator's change succeeds.

   Test Case Derivation: FR16 allows administrators to manage all courses and limits instructors to their own courses.

   How test will be performed: The tester repeats the edit attempt with each role and records whether the change is accepted or denied.

3. ST-FR17: CSV export (FR17)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: Confirmed assessment data exists for at least one course. An administrator account and an instructor account exist.

   Input/Condition: (a) The administrator requests a CSV export of extracted assessment data; (b) the instructor attempts the same export.

   Output/Result: Under (a), a CSV downloads that contains the extracted assessment fields for the selected scope. Under (b), the instructor cannot run the export.

   Test Case Derivation: FR17 allows an administrator to export extracted assessment data as CSV.

   How test will be performed: The tester exports as administrator and opens the file, then confirms that the export control is unavailable to an instructor.

4.1.6 Dashboard and Safety Requirements

These tests cover the new functional requirements FR-Dashboard, FR-Override, and FR-Completeness stated in Section 4.3, and the safety and security re-

quirements SSR_StaleSuggestion, SSR_AuditTrail, and SSR_MasterSheetEdit from the Hazard Analysis.

1. ST-FR18: Course status dashboard (FR-Dashboard)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: A CAS administrator is logged in. Two confirmed outlines exist for the term. Course A has every assessment date and weight and no findings. Course B has Final Exam with date TBD and assessment weights that sum to 90%.

   Input/Condition: The administrator opens the dashboard for the term.

   Output/Result: Both courses are listed. Course A shows its extracted information, no missing fields, and no findings. Course B shows the Final Exam date as missing and a finding that weights do not total 100%, and each item names the course and assessment it applies to.

   Test Case Derivation: FR-Dashboard requires the dashboard to show, for each course, the information found, the information missing, and each finding that needs action.

   How test will be performed: The tester opens the dashboard and compares each course's entries to the handwritten answer key for both outlines.

2. ST-FR19: Accept a finding (FR-Override)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: Course B has two open findings: weights do not total 100%, and a required outline section is missing. An administrator account and an instructor account for Course B exist.

   Input/Condition: (a) The administrator accepts the weight finding with the reason "Weighting approved by the Chair"; (b) the administrator tries to accept the missing-section finding with no reason; (c) the instructor tries to accept the missing-section finding.

   Output/Result: Under (a), the weight finding is shown as accepted instead of open, and a record holds the administrator, the time, and the reason. Under (b), the system asks for a reason and the finding

stays open. Under (c), the instructor cannot accept the finding, and it stays open.

Test Case Derivation: FR-Override allows an administrator to accept a finding with a reason, and requires the administrator, time, and reason to be recorded. FR16 limits instructors to their own course data, which does not include findings.

How test will be performed: The tester performs (a) to (c) through the web interface, then checks the dashboard status of both findings and the stored record for (a).

3. ST-FR20: Term planning status (FR-Completeness)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: A term has three courses with confirmed outlines, and classes have not started. Course A has a confirmed date and weight for every assessment. Course B has Final Exam with date TBD. Course C has Assignment 1 with a blank weight.

   Input/Condition: (a) The administrator views the planning status for the term; (b) the Final Exam date for Course B is set to 2026-04-20 and Assignment 1 in Course C is given a weight of 10%, and both values are confirmed; (c) the administrator views the planning status again.

   Output/Result: Under (a), Course A is reported as fully planned, Courses B and C are reported as not fully planned with the missing date and weight named, and the term is reported as not fully planned. Under (c), all three courses and the term are reported as fully planned.

   Test Case Derivation: FR-Completeness defines a course as fully planned when every assessment has a confirmed date and weight, and requires the status to be reported for each course and for the term.

   How test will be performed: The tester records the status shown under (a), enters and confirms the two missing values, and records the status shown under (c).

4. ST-FR21: Out-of-date suggestion (`SSR_StaleSuggestion`)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

Initial State: The instructor of Course A has requested date suggestions for Midterm 1, which is in a detected conflict, and the suggestions are pending. Course D, taken by the same cohort, has an assessment dated 2026-02-12 in the same week.

Input/Condition: Before the instructor of Course A decides, the instructor of Course D changes that assessment to 2026-03-05.

Output/Result: The pending suggestions for Midterm 1 are marked as out of date, and the instructor of Course A can request new suggestions.

Test Case Derivation: SSR_StaleSuggestion requires a suggestion to be marked out of date if the other assessments in the affected weeks change before the instructor decides on it.

How test will be performed: The tester requests suggestions as the instructor of Course A, changes the Course D date as its instructor, and returns to the pending suggestions as the instructor of Course A.

5. ST-FR22: Audit trail (SSR_AuditTrail)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: Course A has Midterm 1 dated 2026-02-10 with an extracted weight of 30%. The master course sheet expects GAs 1, 2, and 5 for Course A. An administrator account and the instructor account for Course A exist.

   Input/Condition: (a) The instructor changes the Midterm 1 date to 2026-02-12; (b) the administrator corrects the extracted weight from 30% to 25%; (c) the administrator changes the master course sheet row for Course A to expect GAs 1, 2, and 4.

   Output/Result: A record exists for each change that holds the user who made it, the time, and the previous value: 2026-02-10 for (a), 30% for (b), and GAs 1, 2, and 5 for (c).

   Test Case Derivation: SSR_AuditTrail requires the user, the time, and the previous value to be recorded whenever an assessment date, an extracted value, or reference data is changed.

   How test will be performed: The tester makes each change with the stated account, then opens the stored change records and compares each one to the expected values.

6. ST-FR23: Reference data editing (SSR_MasterSheetEdit)

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual

   Initial State: The master course sheet and the academic calendar for the term are loaded. The academic calendar lists reading week as 2026-02-16 to 2026-02-20. An administrator account and an instructor account exist.

   Input/Condition: (a) The instructor tries to change a master course sheet row; (b) the instructor tries to change the reading week dates; (c) the administrator makes both changes.

   Output/Result: Under (a) and (b), the change is denied and the stored values are unchanged. Under (c), both changes are saved.

   Test Case Derivation: SSR_MasterSheetEdit allows only administrators to change the master course sheet and the academic calendar.

   How test will be performed: The tester attempts each change through the web interface and directly through the endpoints, then checks the stored master course sheet and academic calendar.

4.2 Tests for Nonfunctional Requirements

The following tests assess the system-wide nonfunctional requirements. Accuracy measurements use a manually prepared answer key for a representative set of course outlines. Performance measurements will record the test environment, document characteristics, workload, and response times.

4.2.1 Course Outline Processing

1. **NFR-ACC-01: Extraction accuracy**

   Type: Dynamic, automatic

   Initial State: The course-outline processing service is available and the representative test dataset and manually prepared answer key are stored.

   Input/Condition: Submit each test outline for processing.

Output/Result: The final structured output contains the expected assessment dates, assessment weights, and learning outcomes with at least 95% accuracy for each field type. At least 95% of predefined missing, unclear, or incomplete fields are flagged for human review.

How test will be performed: Run the extraction pipeline on every outline, compare the confirmed structured output with the answer key, and calculate precision/recall or an equivalent field-level accuracy for each field type. Calculate missing-field recall as the proportion of known missing or incomplete fields that were flagged. Record the results and compare them with the targets in the Accuracy NFR.

2. **NFR-ACC-03: Policy and CEAB compliance accuracy**

   Type: Dynamic, automatic

   Initial State: The compliance-checking service is available and the representative test dataset has a manually prepared answer key identifying all predefined policy and CEAB compliance issues.

   Input/Condition: Submit each test outline for compliance checking.

   Output/Result: The system identifies at least 95% of the predefined policy and CEAB compliance issues and reports each identified issue in the verification results.

   How test will be performed: Run the compliance checker on every outline, compare the reported issues with the answer key, and calculate recall as the number of correctly identified predefined issues divided by the total number of predefined issues. Record false positives separately and compare the recall with the 95% target in the Accuracy NFR.

3. **NFR-PERF-01: Outline processing time**

   Type: Dynamic, automatic

   Initial State: The processing service is available and the test environment has been recorded. A supported PDF course outline of no more than 30 pages is available.

   Input/Condition: Submit a representative set of supported outlines, including documents with different layouts and extraction sizes.

Output/Result: At least 90% of successful processing runs complete within 60 seconds. Failures and delays caused by unavailable external dependencies are recorded separately.

How test will be performed: Run each outline through the complete document processing and information-extraction workflow, measure elapsed time from submission to structured output, and report the percentile and individual results against the 60-second target in the Performance NFR.

4. **NFR-AI-01: Model input content**

   Type: Dynamic and static, automatic

   Initial State: The test environment logs every request sent to the language model. The master course sheet is loaded, and the test outline's course has a row in it.

   Input/Condition: Submit a representative test outline for processing.

   Output/Result: Each logged model request contains only the text produced by the PDF extraction library and the CEAB graduate attribute definitions. No request contains the PDF file itself or any value from the master course sheet.

   How test will be performed: Process the outline, then compare each logged request with the extracted text, the CEAB definitions, and the master course sheet row for that course. Record any content that does not come from the extracted text or the CEAB definitions, and compare the results with the model input requirements in the SRS.

4.2.2 Calendar and Web Application

1. **NFR-PERF-02: Calendar response time**

   Type: Dynamic, automatic

   Initial State: The database contains the representative processed assessment dataset, the web application is running in the recorded test environment, and the user is authenticated.

Input/Condition: Issue calendar-load requests using representative filters for course, year, and program under the expected concurrent workload.

Output/Result: At least 95% of requests display the previously processed calendar data within 3 seconds.

How test will be performed: Generate repeated calendar-load requests with the defined filters, measure the elapsed time until the calendar data is displayed, and report the response-time distribution and the percentage meeting the 3-second target in the Performance NFR.

2. **NFR-USE-01: Core task completion**

   Type: Dynamic, manual

   Initial State: Representative CAS administrators and course instructors who were not involved in implementation and do not have programming or machine learning knowledge are provided with access to the deployed system and the task scenarios.

   Input/Condition: Each participant attempts the designated core tasks: uploading an outline, reviewing extracted information, viewing and filtering the calendar, interpreting a flagged issue, and exporting available data, without programming or machine learning assistance.

   Output/Result: At least 80% of participants complete each designated core task without assistance or technical knowledge. Any usability issues, errors, requests for help, or evidence of programming or machine learning assistance are recorded.

   How test will be performed: Observe each participant using the system without providing task-specific or technical assistance, record task completion and time, and collect post-task feedback about ease of use. Calculate the completion rate for every task and verify that the results demonstrate use by non-technical participants. Compare the results with the Usability NFR.

3. **NFR-PORT-01: Hosting and browser portability**

   Type: Dynamic, automatic and manual

Initial State: The system is deployed in the designated McMaster University hosting environment. The deployed web application and its core workflows are available on supported desktop operating systems in Google Chrome 120 or later, Mozilla Firefox 121 or later, and Safari 17 or later.

Input/Condition: Run the authentication, outline submission, information review, calendar viewing, and export workflows in each supported browser and on the designated hosting environment.

Output/Result: The system is usable in the designated McMaster University hosting environment and the core workflows complete successfully in each supported browser. Automated accessibility checks report no unresolved high-severity issues against the applicable AODA and WCAG 2.0 Level AA criteria.

How test will be performed: Run an automated accessibility scan, then manually complete the core workflows in every supported browser and on the designated hosting environment. Use keyboard navigation and a screen-reader check, and record the browser, operating system, hosting environment, applicable WCAG success criteria, results, and any deviations against the Portability and Accessibility NFRs.

4.2.3 Security, Reliability, and Deployment

1. **NFR-SEC-01: Access control and data protection**

Type: Dynamic, automatic and manual

Initial State: Test accounts exist for each supported role, including an unauthenticated user, a professor, and a CAS administrator. Test data includes records that each role should and should not be able to access.

Input/Condition: Attempt to access protected pages and API endpoints without authentication, with the wrong role, and with valid permissions. Inspect deployment configuration and logs for exposed credentials or sensitive configuration values.

Output/Result: Unauthenticated and unauthorized requests are rejected. Permitted users can perform only the actions assigned to their roles, and credentials and sensitive configuration values are not exposed.

How test will be performed: Execute the access-control test cases for each role, verify both the user interface and direct endpoint responses, and inspect configuration handling. Record every unexpected access or exposure and compare the results with the Security NFR.

2. **NFR-SEC-02: Model hosting and input privacy**

   Type: Dynamic and static, automatic and manual

   Initial State: The system is deployed in the designated McMaster University hosting environment with its configured language model endpoint. Outbound network connections from the application server are logged. The database contains user accounts and the master course sheet.

   Input/Condition: Process a batch of representative test outlines from upload to confirmed structured data.

   Output/Result: Every model request is sent only to the configured model endpoint, and the application makes no other outbound connection while processing. No model request contains confidential department data or personal information about any user or student. Course and department data are stored only on CAS-hosted infrastructure.

   How test will be performed: Process the batch while capturing outbound connections, then compare every destination with the configured model endpoint. Search the logged model requests for master course sheet values and user account details. Inspect the deployment configuration for any external model endpoint or storage location, and compare the results with the hosting and model input privacy requirements in the SRS.

3. **NFR-REL-01: Invalid input and dependency failure recovery**

   Type: Dynamic, automatic

   Initial State: The database contains valid course, assessment, and calendar records. A submitted outline is retained by the system.

   Input/Condition: Submit an unsupported, malformed, oversized, incomplete, or unreadable outline, and separately make the extraction or recommendation service unavailable during processing.

Output/Result: The system reports an actionable error without crashing, corrupting or deleting existing records, and retains the submitted outline for retry. While the external service is unavailable, users can still view and edit stored information, view the calendar, and export available data.

How test will be performed: Run each invalid-input and dependency-failure scenario, verify the response and stored data before and after the failure, and retry processing after restoring the dependency. Record whether each predefined case meets the Reliability NFR.

4. **NFR-DEP-01: Deployment and maintainability**

Type: Static and dynamic, manual

Initial State: A clean designated McMaster University hosting environment and the documented installation and deployment instructions are available to a maintainer who did not perform the original setup.

Input/Condition: Deploy the system by following the documentation. Verify that the documentation identifies the required software, configuration values, environment variables, database setup, and service startup steps. Then implement representative isolated changes to document processing, scheduling, or compliance rules.

Output/Result: The maintainer can deploy the system to the designated McMaster University hosting environment and complete the core workflow without undocumented steps. The documentation contains all required setup information. The representative changes do not require unrelated components to be rewritten, and the effort for each change is recorded relative to the original implementation effort for the affected component.

How test will be performed: Give the documentation and clean hosting environment to a new maintainer without providing undocumented guidance. Observe the maintainer follow the installation and deployment instructions, execute the core workflow, and record any missing or ambiguous steps. Review the change diffs and effort records with the team, then document the results against the Installability, Deployability, and Maintainability NFRs.

5. **NFR-DATA-01: Data retention**

   Type: Static and dynamic, manual

   Initial State: The test database contains outlines, extracted data, findings, and change records, including fixture records dated 9 years before the test date.

   Input/Condition: Run every scheduled maintenance and cleanup job that the system defines. Inspect the configured retention period.

   Output/Result: No record dated less than 10 years before the test date is deleted by an automatic process, and the configured retention period is 10 years.

   How test will be performed: Count the records of each type before and after running the jobs, and check that the 9-year-old fixture records remain. Inspect the retention configuration and the code paths that delete stored records, and compare the results with the retention requirement in the SRS.

4.3 Traceability Between Test Cases and Requirements

Table 4 traces every requirement to the system tests that verify it and to the non-dynamic techniques that give further evidence. It covers the functional (FR), nonfunctional (NFR), data (DR), and AI and machine learning (AIR) requirements in the SRS [1], and the safety and security requirements (SSR) in the Hazard Analysis [4]. Requirements are identified by their numbers in those documents.

New requirements. Three new functional requirements are not yet part of the SRS. They are stated below and traced in Table 4 under these names.

FR-Dashboard: The system shall display a dashboard that shows, for each course, the information found in its outline, the information that is missing, and each finding that needs action.

FR-Override: The system shall allow an administrator to mark a finding as accepted, with a reason. The system shall then show the finding as accepted instead of open, and shall record the administrator, the time, and the reason.

FR-Completeness: The system shall report, for each course and for the term as a whole, whether the course is fully planned before classes start. A course is fully planned when every assessment in its outline has a confirmed date and weight.

Non-dynamic techniques. Where a requirement is also checked without running the system, the technique is listed in Table 4:

- **CR (code review):** the pull request reviewer checks the code that implements the requirement against the requirement text.
- **SA (static analysis):** linters, type checking, and dependency and secret scanning run in continuous integration.
- **DI (document and configuration inspection):** a team member who did not write the artifact inspects a document, data file, or configuration against the requirement.
- **WT (walkthrough):** the team walks a supervisor or stakeholder through the feature on sample outlines and records their feedback.

Table 4: Traceability Between System Tests and Requirements

Requirement	System tests	Non-dynamic
Functional requirements		
FR1	ST-FR1	CR
FR2	ST-FR2, NFR-ACC-01	–
FR3	ST-FR3, NFR-ACC-01	WT
FR4	ST-FR4, NFR-ACC-01	–
FR5	ST-FR5	CR
FR6	ST-FR6	–
FR7	ST-FR7, NFR-PERF-02	WT
FR8	ST-FR8	CR
FR9	ST-FR9	CR
FR10	ST-FR10	CR

Requirement	System tests	Non-dynamic
FR11	ST-FR11	CR
FR12	ST-FR12	CR
FR13	ST-FR13, NFR-ACC-03	CR
FR14	ST-FR14, NFR-ACC-03	WT
FR15	ST-FR15, NFR-SEC-01	CR
FR16	ST-FR16, ST-FR6, NFR-SEC-01	CR
FR17	ST-FR17	–
FR-Dashboard	ST-FR18, NFR-USE-01	WT
FR-Override	ST-FR19	CR
FR-Completeness	ST-FR20	–
Nonfunctional requirements		
NFR1	NFR-ACC-01, NFR-ACC-03	DI
NFR2	NFR-USE-01	WT
NFR3	NFR-DEP-01	CR, SA
NFR4	NFR-PORT-01	–
NFR5	NFR-DEP-01	DI
NFR6	NFR-PERF-01, NFR-PERF-02	–
NFR7	NFR-REL-01	–
NFR8	NFR-SEC-01	SA
NFR9	NFR-PORT-01	–
Data requirements		
DR1	NFR-SEC-01	–
DR2	NFR-SEC-02	CR, DI
DR3	ST-FR16, NFR-SEC-01	–
DR4	NFR-DATA-01	DI
AI and machine learning requirements		
AIR1	NFR-AI-01	CR
AIR2	NFR-SEC-02	CR
AIR3	ST-FR2, ST-FR3	–
AIR4	ST-FR2, ST-FR3	–

Requirement	System tests	Non-dynamic
AIR5	ST-FR4, NFR-ACC-01	–
AIR6	ST-FR5	CR
Safety and security requirements (Hazard Analysis)		
SSR1	NFR-REL-01	–
SSR2	ST-FR1	CR
SSR3	ST-FR11	CR
SSR4	ST-FR21	CR
SSR5	ST-FR13, ST-FR14	–
SSR6	ST-FR22	–
SSR7	ST-FR23	–

Summary of coverage. Table 4 traces 46 requirements, and every requirement is verified by at least one system test. Where a single test is the only dynamic check, a non-dynamic technique is often added. For example, the 10-year retention period in DR4 cannot be observed within the project, so NFR-DATA-01 checks that no automatic process deletes stored records, and a DI inspection confirms the retention setting. Some tests verify more than one requirement. NFR-SEC-01, which checks access control and data protection, supports FR15, FR16, NFR8, DR1, and DR3. A failure in a shared test affects every requirement it traces to, so shared tests are given high priority.

5 Unit Test Description

[This section should not be filled in until after the MIS (detailed design document) has been completed. —SS]

[Reference your MIS (detailed design document) and explain your overall philosophy for test case selection. —SS]

[To save space and time, it may be an option to provide less detail in this section. For the unit tests you can potentially layout your testing strategy here. That is, you can explain how tests will be selected for each module. For instance, your test building approach could be test cases for each access program, including one test for normal behaviour and as many tests as needed

for edge cases. Rather than create the details of the input and output here, you could point to the unit testing code. For this to work, you code needs to be well-documented, with meaningful names for all of the tests. —SS]

5.1 Unit Testing Scope

[Explain what is and is not in unit-test scope once the design is available. —SS]

5.2 Tests for Functional Requirements

[Add module unit tests here after MIS. —SS]

5.2.1 Module ?

[Include a blurb here to explain why the subsections below cover the module. References to the MIS would be good. You will want tests from a black box perspective and from a white box perspective. Explain to the reader how the tests were selected. —SS]

1. test-id1

   Type: [Functional, Dynamic, Manual, Automatic, Static etc. Most will be automatic —SS]

   Initial State:

   Input:

   Output: [The expected result for the given inputs —SS]

   Test Case Derivation: [Justify the expected value given in the Output field —SS]

   How test will be performed:

2. test-id2

   Type: [Functional, Dynamic, Manual, Automatic, Static etc. Most will be automatic —SS]

   Initial State:

Input:

Output: [The expected result for the given inputs —SS]

Test Case Derivation: [Justify the expected value given in the Output field —SS]

How test will be performed:

3. ...

5.2.2 Module ?

...

5.3 Tests for Nonfunctional Requirements

[If there is a module that needs to be independently assessed for performance, those test cases can go here. In some projects, planning for nonfunctional tests of units will not be that relevant. —SS]

[These tests may involve collecting performance data from previously mentioned functional tests. —SS]

5.3.1 Module ?

1. test-id1

   Type: [Functional, Dynamic, Manual, Automatic, Static etc. Most will be automatic —SS]

   Initial State:

   Input/Condition:

   Output/Result:

   How test will be performed:

2. test-id2

   Type: Functional, Dynamic, Manual, Static etc.

   Initial State:

Input:

Output:

How test will be performed:

5.3.2 Module ?

...

5.4 Traceability Between Test Cases and Modules

[Provide evidence that all modules have been considered. —SS]

References

[1] S. Mehta, A. Bornomala, H. S. Sagar, and V. Lai, "Software Requirements Specification: CAS Course Deadline Management System," Team 19 (BVSH), Dept. of Computing and Software, McMaster University, Hamilton, ON, Canada, Oct. 2026, Accessed: Oct. 19, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://github.com/shivyam/cas-course-optimization/blob/main/pdfs/SRS-IEEE/SRS.pdf

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[4] S. Mehta, A. Bornomala, H. S. Sagar, and V. Lai, "Hazard Analysis," Team 19 (BVSH), Dept. of Computing and Software, McMaster University, Hamilton, ON, Canada, Oct. 2026, Accessed: Nov. 1, 2026. [On-

line]. Available: https://github.com/shivyam/cas-course-optimization/blob/main/pdfs/HazardAnalysis/HazardAnalysis.pdf

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6 Appendix

This is where you can place additional information.

6.1 Symbolic Parameters

The system tests use these constants. Values match the SRS auxiliary constants where applicable.

- Cluster window = 7 days
- Cluster threshold = 3
- Min alternatives = 2
- Weight total = 100%
- Max outline size = 5 MB (SSR_AcceptedFiles)

6.2 Usability Survey Questions

The following questions will be provided to participants after they complete the usability tasks described in the Software Validation section. Unless otherwise specified, participants will answer using a five-point Likert scale: 1 = strongly disagree, 2 = disagree, 3 = neither agree nor disagree, 4 = agree, and 5 = strongly agree. Participants may also select "Not Applicable" where a question does not apply to a task they completed.

Post-Task Questions

1. I understood what to do when uploading a course outline.
2. I could tell whether the course outline was processed successfully.
3. The extracted assessment information was easy to review and correct.
4. The system made missing, unclear, or incomplete information easy to identify.
5. The assessment calendar was easy to find and understand.
6. The course, year, and program filters behaved as I expected.

7. I could export the course or assessment information without assistance.
8. I could complete the tasks using the system without programming or machine learning knowledge.

Overall Questions

1. The system supports the way I would review course outlines and assessment schedules.
2. The information displayed by the system is presented at an appropriate level of detail.
3. The terminology used by the system is clear.
4. I would feel confident using this system for my course-outline or scheduling-related work.

Open-Ended Questions

1. Which task was easiest to complete, and why?
2. Which task was most difficult to complete, and why?
3. What information, control, or explanation was missing?
4. Did any result, flag, or recommendation seem unclear or incorrect? If so, please describe it.
5. What changes would make the system more useful for your work?

Survey Administration and Analysis

Participants will complete the survey immediately after the task-based session. The team will record the participant role (CAS administrator, Stakeholder), task completion without assistance, time spent on each task, and any observed errors separately from the questionnaire responses. For each closed-ended question, the team will report the number of responses, the median rating, and the response distribution. The task completion results will be compared with the 80% usability target, while the open-ended responses and observed difficulties will be grouped into themes and used to prioritize interface, workflow, and documentation changes.

7 Appendix — Generative AI Use Disclosure

7.1 AI Tools Used

The following AI tools were used:

- Grok (version 4.7)
- Claude (Anthropic), Claude Opus 5.5 model
- ChatGPT (OpenAI), GPT-4-turbo model
- GitHub Copilot (version 1.79.0)

7.2 How and Where Used

The tools were used in the following manner:

- Grok was used to fix formatting issues and address pull request comments in Sections 2.1, 3.1, 3.3, and 4.1.
- Claude was used to review and refine the document, suggesting improvements to structure and clarity, and assisting with grammar and style. It was used to primarily refine the Sections 3.4, 4.1, and 4.3.
- ChatGPT and Copilot were used for formatting and grammar suggestions, and to assist with the writing of the Sections 2.2, 2.3, 3.2, 3.6, 4.2, and 6.2.

7.3 Verification of AI-Generated Content

Any output by LLM models was reviewed thoroughly and modified before its suggestions were added to the document. Course materials and deliverable requirements were manually reviewed to ensure that all technical assertions, requirements, and references were accurate and complete.

8 Appendix — Reflection

1. What went well while writing this deliverable?

   One positive aspect of writing the V&V Plan was that it encouraged our team to think more critically about how we will evaluate the reliability and correctness of our system before implementation is complete. In particular, we were able to identify which components require the most attention during testing, such as document processing, information extraction through the external LLM, and data validation. Having previously discussed potential risks in our Hazard Analysis, we were able to use those findings to guide our testing priorities and identify the qualities that are most important to verify. Additionally, dividing the sections among team members and reviewing each other's contributions helped us consider different testing approaches and ensure that our plans were realistic within the project's scope and timeline.

2. What pain points did you experience during this deliverable, and how did you resolve them?

   One of the main challenges we experienced was determining how to create specific and measurable test cases for a system that relies on document processing and LLM-based information extraction. Since course outlines can vary significantly in their formatting and content, and LLM-generated outputs may not always be consistent, it was difficult to establish expected results that would adequately represent real-world scenarios. We addressed this by planning to use a representative collection of course outlines alongside manually prepared answer keys, allowing us to compare extracted information against known expected results and measure accuracy. Another challenge was deciding which quality attributes to prioritize, as many aspects of the system could be tested within the limited time available. We resolved this by focusing on qualities that have the greatest impact on the system's purpose, particularly correctness, reliability, and traceability, while still including basic usability, performance, and security testing. We also found it challenging to distinguish between testing our own implementation and verifying external dependencies, which led us to clarify that our testing would focus on the behavior of our integrations rather than the internal implementations of third-party components.

3. What knowledge and skills will the team collectively need to acquire to successfully complete the verification and validation of your project? Examples of possible knowledge and skills include dynamic testing knowledge, static testing knowledge, specific tool usage, Valgrind etc. You should look to identify at least one item for each team member.

   As a team, we will need to develop practical experience with several testing techniques and tools to successfully complete the verification and validation of our system, ASSURE, as per our respective strengths and roles:

   - Vanessa: Strengthening knowledge of integration and functional testing, to verify the system's core functionality, including outline intake, scheduling, and compliance workflows.
   - Harman: Developing knowledge of data validation, security testing, and privacy verification to ensure that information is handled correctly and that access restrictions are enforced.
   - Shivya: Gaining experience with non-functional testing, including performance, usability, reliability, and deployment testing, to evaluate how effectively the system performs under its expected conditions.
   - Anindita: Developing skills in evaluating LLM-based information extraction, including measuring accuracy, identifying outputs that are unsupported, and verifying that extracted information can be traced back to its original source.

4. For each of the knowledge areas and skills identified in the previous question, what are at least two approaches to acquiring the knowledge or mastering the skill? Of the identified approaches, which will each team member pursue, and why did they make this choice?

   Our team plans to develop these skills through a combination of reviewing documentation and tutorials, and gaining practical experience through hands-on testing. We will use the following division of approaches based on each team members strengths and areas of familiarity:

   - Vanessa: Study testing frameworks such as Pytest and apply knowledge by developing test cases for the system's core workflows.

- Harman: Review security and data validation resources and practice testing access controls, invalid inputs, and data handling scenarios.
- Shivya: Explore performance and usability testing techniques and apply them by measuring processing times, evaluating responsiveness, and assessing whether users can complete core tasks.
- Anindita: Review LLM evaluation techniques and use representative course outlines and manually prepared answer keys to measure extraction accuracy and identify any inconsistencies.

Each team member will also share their findings through discussions, code reviews, and documentation to support collective learning.